

A Long-Awaited Desideratum: MEI Encoding of Byzantine Neumes (Chrysanthine Notation)

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³Greek RISM office

²Aristotle University of Thessaloniki

⁴McGill University

International Association of Music Libraries (IAML) Congress
30 June 2026

1400 years since the first written testimonium about the Akathistos Hymn

Video by the Christian Student Action of Thessaloniki



https://www.youtube.com/watch?app=desktop&v=4_w6EWdtGHk

Το αρχικό προοίμιο ->

Προοίμιον Ι	
Τὸ προσταχθέν	
Εφύμνιο Ι	-> Χαίρε νύμφη ἀνύμφευτε

Το β' προοίμιο,
νικητήριος ύμνος

Προοίμιον ΙΙ	
Τὴ Ὑπερμάχῳ	->
Εφύμνιο Ι	-> Χαίρε νύμφη ἀνύμφευτε

Μεταγενέστερη
προσθήκη
Εφύμνιο ΙΙ

(Προοίμιον ΙΙΙ)	
Οὐ πανόμεθα	->
Εφύμνιο ΙΙ	-> Χαίρε ἡ Κεχαριτωμένη

ΠΡΟΟΙΜΙΑ

Οἶκος Α'

Ἄγγελος πρωτοστάτης
Χαιρετισμοί (12 στίχοι)
Χαίρε νύμφη ἀνύμφευτε

-> Μετρικό και μουσικό μοντέλο
για τους υπόλοιπους οἴκους
με περιττό αριθμό

-> Εφύμνιο Ι, θεομητορικό

Οἶκος Β'

Βλέπουσα ἡ Ἀγία
Ἀλληλουῖα

-> Μετρικό και μουσικό μοντέλο
για τους οἴκους με ἄρτιο αριθμό
-> Εφύμνιο ΙΙΙ, δεσποτικό
= αἰνεῖτε τὸν Κύριον

Οἶκος Γ'

Γνώσιν ἄγνωστον
Χαιρετισμοί (12 στίχοι)
Χαίρε νύμφη ἀνύμφευτε

Οἶκος Δ'

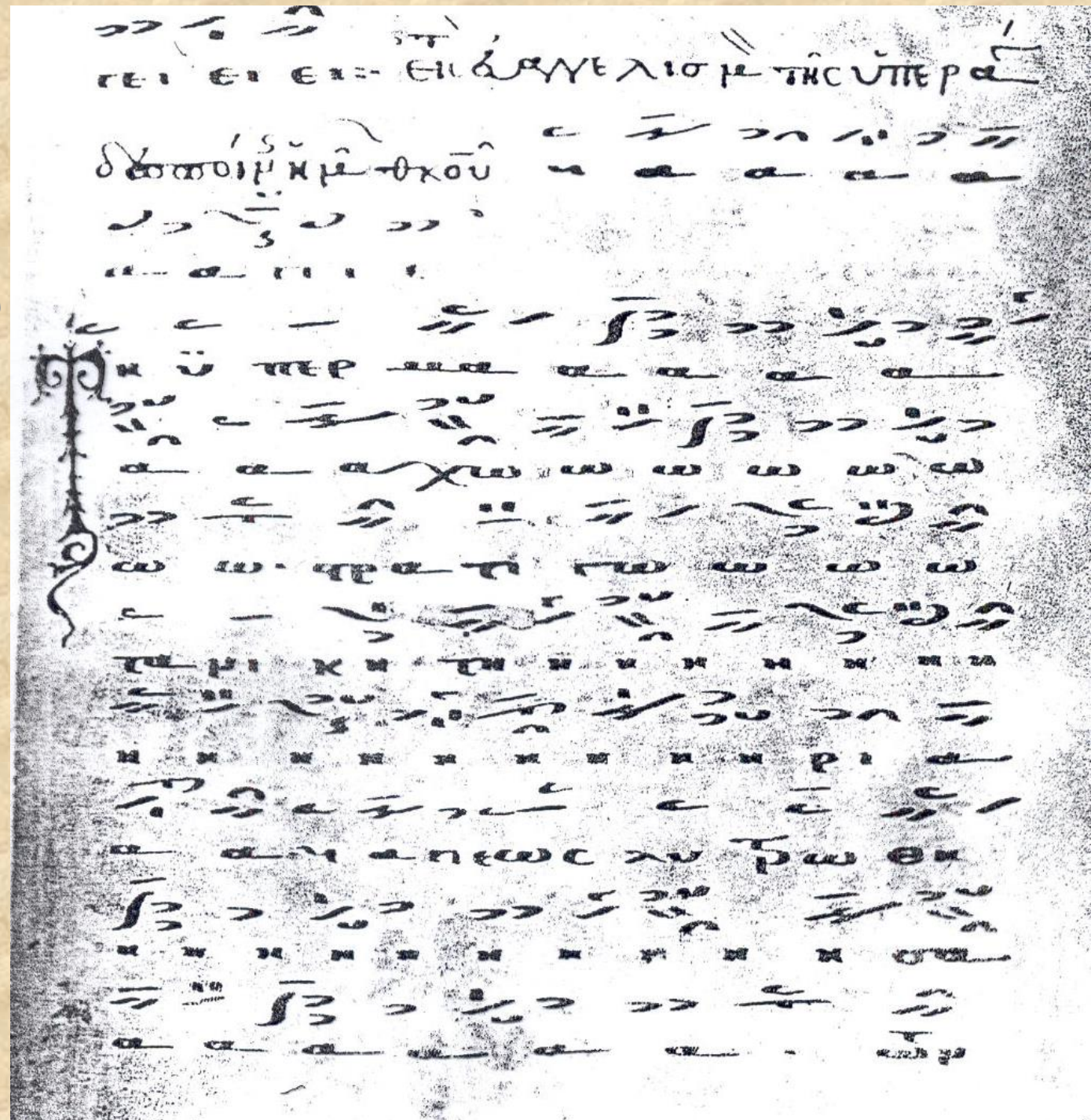
Δύναμις τοῦ Ὑψίστου
Ἀλληλουῖα

... παρομοίως μέχρι τον Οἶκο ΚΔ'

24 ΟΙΚΟΙ με
αλφαβητική
ακροστιχίδα ->
Α-Μ: ιστορικό μέρος
Ν-Ω: θεολογικό-
δογματικό μέρος

Αρχή της
ανώνυμης μελισματικής
μελοποίησης ολόκληρου του
Ακαθίστου, από το
χειρόγραφο
Ashburnhamensis L 64, φ.
108α, έτ. 1289, προέλευση:
Κρυπτοφέρρη.

Εικόνα από: *Contacarium
Ashburnhamense*, επιμ.
Carsten Høeg, MMB, Série
principale 4 (Copenhagen:
Munksgaard, 1956).



Spyrakou, “When Iconography and *Typika* Meet: Performing the Ἀκάθιστος Ὑμνος in Time and Space” (2025), σσ. 57-78

Musical performance:

1. **Litanies outside the churches,** in the cities usually with the icon of Theotokos Hodegetria (Constantinople, Thessaloniki, Arta), with the participation of chanters, clerics, asketria (women chanters), large parts of the population of all ages, as well as children, singing *Τῇ Ὑπερμάχῳ κ.ά.* (testimonia since the 11th cent.)

4 WHEN ICONOGRAPHY AND *TYPIKA* MEET: PERFORMING... 61



Fig. 4.1 Oikoi 23 and 24 in the sanctuary of Marko Monastery; photograph: Elizabeta Dimitrova (with the kind permission of the Ministry of Culture of the Republic of Macedonia, Cultural Heritage Protection Office)

Το β' προοίμιον του Ακαθίστου Ύμνου, κείμενο 7ου αι., μέλος ανώνυμο. Πηγή:

Μουσικός Πανδέκτης, τ. Γ', 8η έκδ., Αθήνα 2005: Ζωή, σ. 336

γ
δ

Τ η υ περ μα α χω ρα τη γω τα νι κη τη
η ρι α λ ως λυ τρω θει ει σα των δει νων ευ
χα ρι σ η ρι ι α λ α να γρα φω σοι η πο
λι ις σ θε ο το κε δ αλλ ως ε ε χ θ σα το
κρα τος α προσ μα α χη τον λ εκ παν τοι ων
με κιν δυ νων ε ε λευ θε ρω σον ι να κρα ζω ω σοι
χαι ρε νυ υμ φη α νυ υμ φευ τε ε ε ε

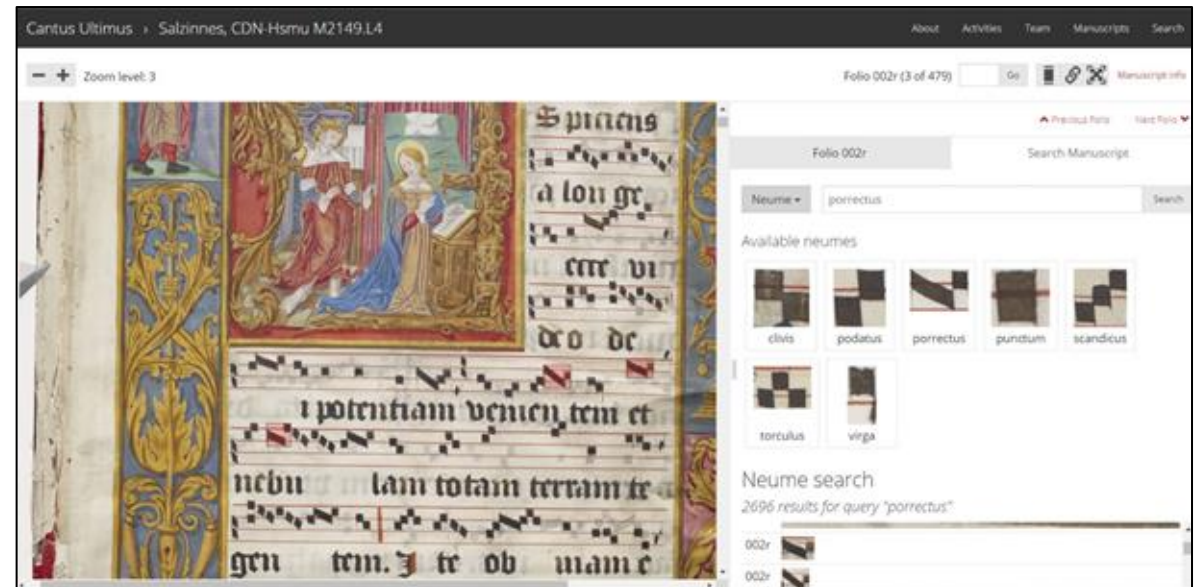
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What is MEI?
And why do we want to use it?

Music Encoding Initiative (MEI)

- It is both a *community* and a *symbolic music format*
- Goal: **define the best practices** to encode a **wide variety** of **music documents**
- **Community**: music librarians and archivists, music theorists, musicologists, and technicians
- **Symbolic format supports the encoding of**:
 - **CWMN** (Common Western Music Notation)
 - **(Western) Early Music**: Western neumes, mensural notation, tablature
 - It is **easily customizable and extensible** (by design) → easy extension to support *other repertoires and notations*
- **Digital editions**
- **Establish connections** between the (encoded) music text and the **facsimile**
- and much more



Music Encoding Initiative (MEI)

• Cantus Ultimus › Salzinnes, CDN-Hsmu M2149.L4

•  Zoom level: 3

• Folio 002r (3 of 479)     [Manuscript info](#)

•  Previous Folio [Next Folio](#) 

• Folio 002r Search Manuscript

• Neume  

Available neumes

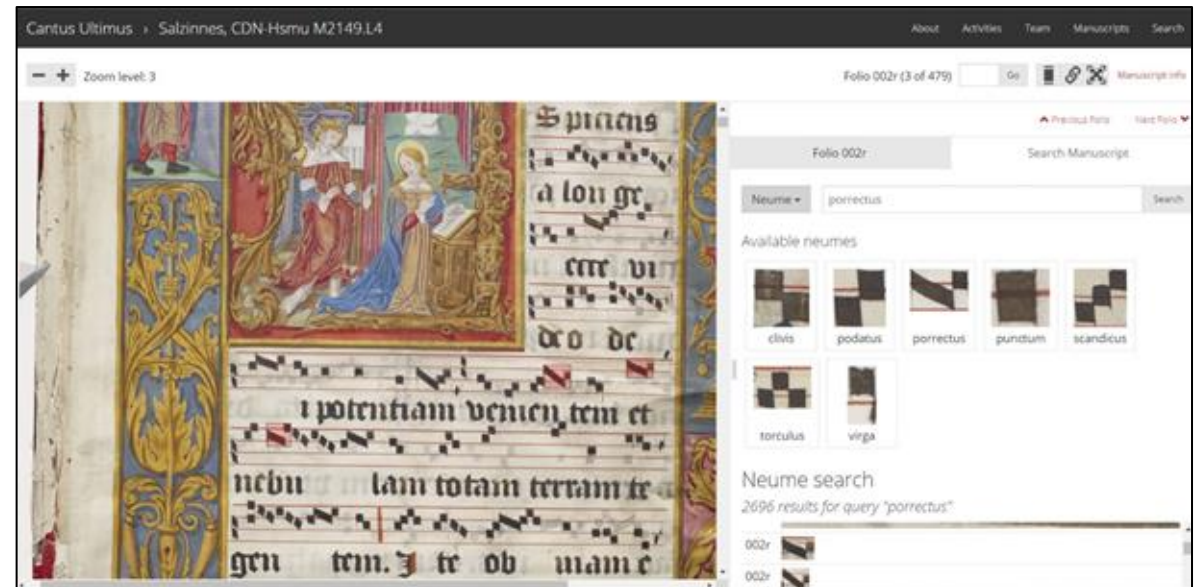
 clivis	 podatus	 porrectus	 punctum	 scandicus
 torculus	 virga			

Neume search
2696 results for query "porrectus"

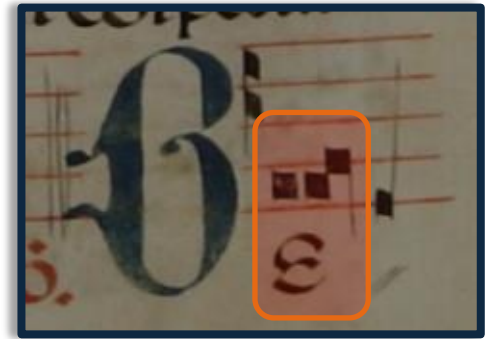
002r	
002r	

Music Encoding Initiative (MEI)

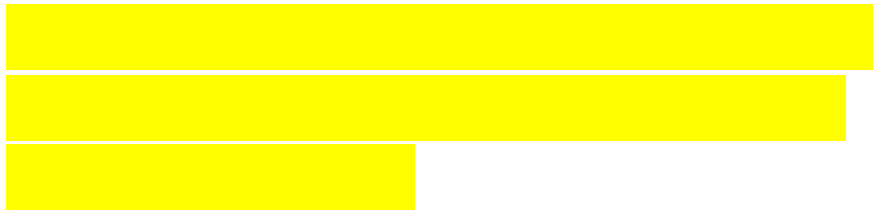
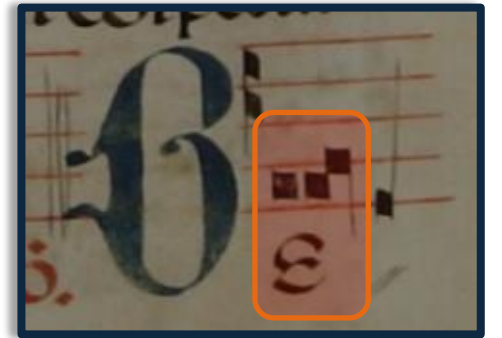
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Usual Structure of MEI Neumes Encoding (Western chant)



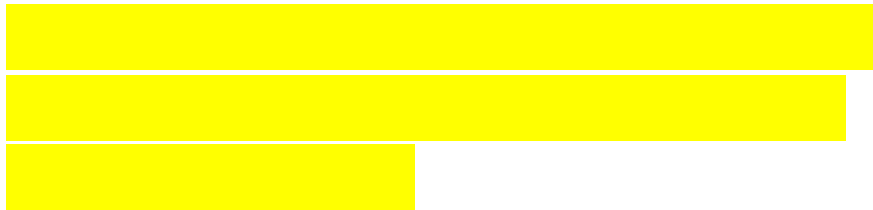
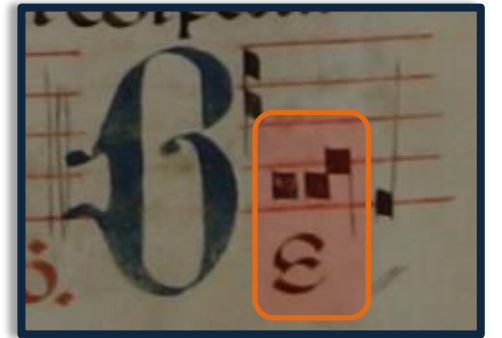
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<syllable>  
  <syl>Be</syl>  
  <neume>  
    <nc pname="e" oct="3"/>  
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  </neume>  
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```

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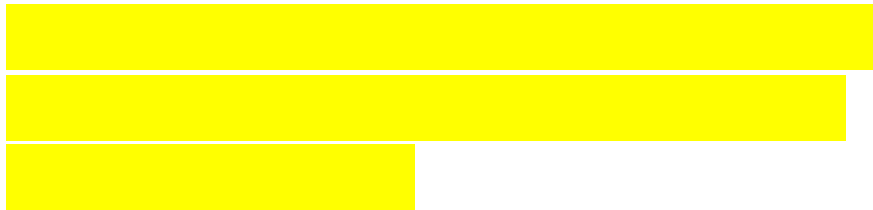
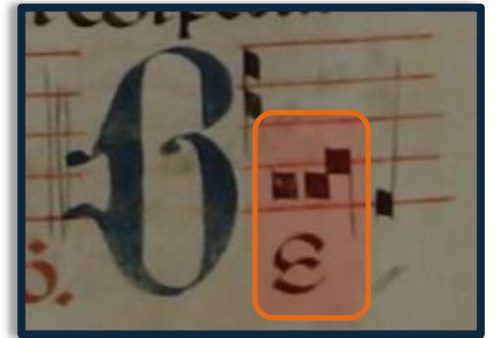


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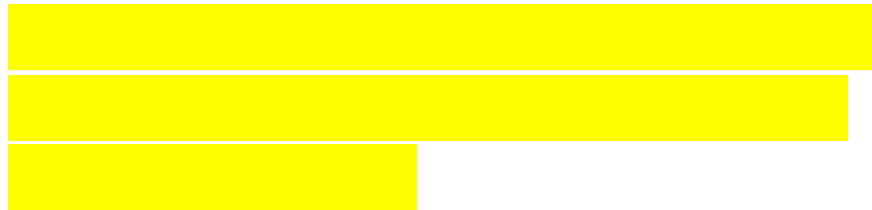
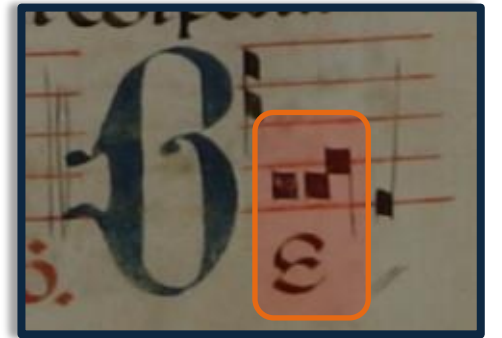
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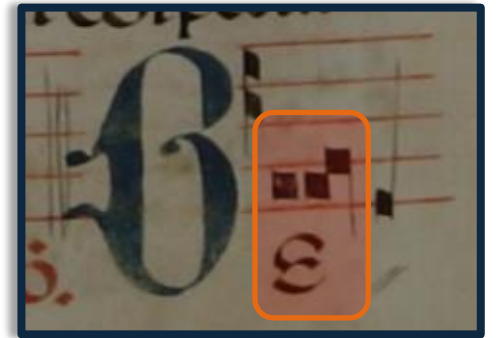
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A neume component is defined as “sign representing a single pitched event”



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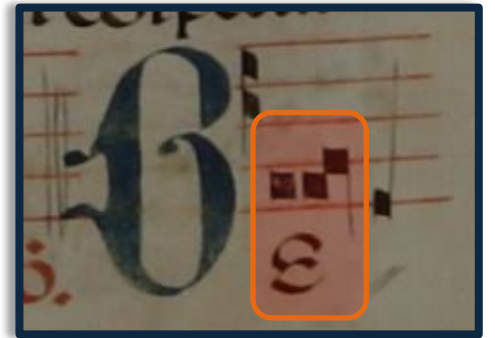
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Proposal
for the **MEI Encoding**
of **Byzantine Neumes**
of the *New System*
(in use since 1814)

MEI Encoding for Byzantine Neumes

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In **neume combinations**,
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combinations
neumes



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```
<syllable>
  <syl>cho</syl>
  <neume dur="2" intmb="-1" intm="-2">
    <neume func="melodic"
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<syllable> — Container element for everything that belongs to a syllable (neumes and text)

↳ **<sy1>** — Contains the **actual text syllable**

↳ **<neume>** — **Neumes** related to that syllable

combinations
neumes



Will contain **attributes** to define:

↳ **Pitch** (@intmb) } **parent**

↳ **Duration** (@dur) } **neume**

↳ **Name** (for “basic neumes”)

↳ **Functionality** (for “basic neumes”)

```
<syllable>
  <sy1>cho</sy1>
  <neume dur="2" intmb="-1" intm="-2">
    <neume func="melodic"
      name="apostrofos" pos="main"/>
    <neume func="temporal"
      name="klasma" pos="above"/>
  </neume>
</syllable>
```


MEI Encoding for Byzantine Neumes

<syllable> — **Container element** for everything that belongs to a syllable (neumes and text)

↳ **<sy1>** — Contains the **actual text syllable**

↳ **<neume>** — **Neumes** related to that syllable

combinations
neumes



Will contain **attributes** to define:

↳ **Pitch** (@intmb) } **parent**
↳ **Duration** (@dur) } **neume**

↳ **Name** (for “basic neumes”)

↳ **Functionality** (for “basic neumes”)

↳ **Position** (@pos for “basic neumes”)

```
<syllable>
  <sy1>cho</sy1>
  <neume dur="2" intmb="-1" intm="-2">
    <neume func="melodic"
      name="apostrofos" pos="main"/>
    <neume func="temporal"
      name="klasma" pos="above"/>
  </neume>
</syllable>
```

MEI Encoding for **Byzantine Neumes**

The “parent neume” contains the pitch and duration information derived from the “basic (children) neumes” contained within

MEI Encoding for Byzantine Neumes

The “parent neume” contains the pitch and duration information derived from the “basic (children) neumes” contained within

TWO EXCEPTIONS

- **Dyo kendimata with oligon:**



In this combination of *dyo kendimata* above/below *oligon*, each individual neume—the *dyo kendimata* and the *oligon*—has its own pitch (and duration)

- **Iporroi:**



This “basic neume” represents two notes (two descending voices in scalar movement [-1 -1]). Therefore, each note within the `<neume name="iporroi">` has its own pitch (and duration)

Basic
Interval
Neumes
@func
melodic

Shape	Name	Encoding	Description	Interval Sign
	Ison (Íson)	<neume func="melodic" name="ison" intm="0" intmb="0"/>	Keep the same step (0)	basic interval sign
	Olígon	<neume func="melodic" name="oligon" intm="+2" intmb="+1"/>	One ascending step (+1)	basic interval sign
	Oxeía (Oxía)	<neume func="melodic" name="oxia" intm="+2" intmb="+1"/>	One ascending step (+1), with dynamic or ornamental accent	basic interval sign
	Petasté (Petastí)	<neume func="melodic" name="petasti" intm="+2" intmb="+1"/>	One ascending step (+1), with ornament	basic interval sign
	Dýo kentémata (Dío kendímata)	<neume func="melodic" name="dyo-kendimata" intm="+2" intmb="+1"/>	One ascending step (+1), with legato	basic interval sign
	Kéntēma (Kéndima)	<neume func="melodic" name="kendima"/>	Two ascending steps (+2)	Never stands alone, but in combination with another basic interval sign
	Hypsēlé (Ipsilí)	<neume func="melodic" name="ipsili"/>	Four ascending steps (+4)	
	Apóstrophos (Apóstrofos)	<neume func="melodic" name="apostrofos" intm="-2" intmb="-1"/>	One descending step (-1)	
	Hyporrhoe (Iporroi)	<neume func="melodic" name="iporroi"> <note intm="-2" intmb="-1" slur="m"/> <note intm="-2" intmb="-1" slur="t"/> </neume>	Two descending steps in scalar movement (-1-1), with legato starting from the previous note	
	Elaphrón (Elafrón)	<neume func="melodic" name="elafron" intm="-3" intmb="-2"/>	Two descending steps leap (-2)	
	Khamēlé or Chamēlé (Hamilí)	<neume func="melodic" name="hamili" intm="-5" intmb="-4"/>	Four descending steps (-4)	

Basic
Interval
Neumes
@func
melodic

Shape	Name	Encoding	Description	Interval Sign
	Ison (Íson)	<neume func="melodic" name="ison" intm="0" intmb="0"/>	Keep the same step (0)	basic interval sign
	Olígon	<neume func="melodic" name="oligon" intm="+2" intmb="+1"/>	One ascending step (+1)	basic interval sign
	Oxeía (Oxía)	<neume func="melodic" name="oxia" intm="+2" intmb="+1"/>	One ascending step (+1), with dynamic or ornamental accent	basic interval sign
	Petasté (Petastí)	<neume func="melodic" name="petasti" intm="+2" intmb="+1"/>	One ascending step (+1), with ornament	basic interval sign
	Dýo kentémata (Dío kendímata)	<neume func="melodic" name="dyo-kendimata" intm="+2" intmb="+1"/>	One ascending step (+1), with legato	basic interval sign
	Kéntēma (Kéndima)	<neume func="melodic" name="kendima"/>	Two ascending steps (+2)	Never stands alone, but in combination with another basic interval sign
	Hypsēlé (Ipsilí)	<neume func="melodic" name="ipsili"/>	Four ascending steps (+4)	
	Apóstrophos (Apóstrofos)	<neume func="melodic" name="apostrofos" intm="-2" intmb="-1"/>	One descending step (-1)	
	Hyporrhoe (Iporroi)	<neume func="melodic" name="iporroi"> <note intm="-2" intmb="-1" slur="m"/> <note intm="-2" intmb="-1" slur="t"/> </neume>	Two descending steps in scalar movement (-1-1), with legato starting from the previous note	
	Elaphrón (Elafrón)	<neume func="melodic" name="elafron" intm="-3" intmb="-2"/>	Two descending steps leap (-2)	
	Khamēlé or Chamēlé (Hamilí)	<neume func="melodic" name="hamili" intm="-5" intmb="-4"/>	Four descending steps (-4)	

Basic
Interval
Neumes
@func
melodic

Shape	Name	Encoding	Description	Interval Sign
	Ison (Íson)	<neume func="melodic" name="ison" intm="0" intmb="0"/>	Keep the same step (0)	basic interval sign
	Olígon	<neume func="melodic" name="oligon" intm="+2" intmb="+1"/>	One ascending step (+1)	basic interval sign
	Oxeía (Oxía)	<neume func="melodic" name="oxia" intm="+2" intmb="+1"/>	One ascending step (+1), with dynamic or ornamental accent	basic interval sign
	Petasté (Petastí)	<neume func="melodic" name="petasti" intm="+2" intmb="+1"/>	One ascending step (+1), with ornament	basic interval sign
	Dýo kentémata (Dío kendímata)	<neume func="melodic" name="dyo-kendimata" intm="+2" intmb="+1"/>	One ascending step (+1), with legato	basic interval sign
	Kéntēma (Kéndima)	<neume func="melodic" name="kendima"/>	Two ascending steps (+2)	Never stands alone, but in combination with another basic interval sign
	Hypsēlé (Ipsilí)	<neume func="melodic" name="ipsili"/>	Four ascending steps (+4)	
	Apóstrophos (Apóstrofos)	<neume func="melodic" name="apostrofos" intm="-2" intmb="-1"/>	One descending step (-1)	
	Hyporrhoe (Iporroi)	<neume func="melodic" name="iporroi"> <note intm="-2" intmb="-1" slur="m"/> <note intm="-2" intmb="-1" slur="t"/> </neume>	Two descending steps in scalar movement (-1-1), with legato starting from the previous note	
	Elaphrón (Elafrón)	<neume func="melodic" name="elafron" intm="-3" intmb="-2"/>	Two descending steps leap (-2)	
	Khamēlé or Chamēlé (Hamilí)	<neume func="melodic" name="hamili" intm="-5" intmb="-4"/>	Four descending steps (-4)	

Compound Interval Neumes EXAMPLES

Shape	Name	Meaning	Encoding
	Oligon (Olígon) + Kéntēma (Kéndima) above + Hypsēlé (Ipsilí) front right	Six ascending steps of the scale (+6) [ascending seventh]	<pre><neume intm="+7" intmb="+6"> <neume func="melodic" name="oligon" pos="main"/> <neume func="melodic" name="kendima" pos="above"/> <neume func="melodic" name="ipsili" pos="front right"/> </neume></pre>
	Oligon (Olígon) + Kéntēma (Kéndima) above + Hypsēlé (Ipsilí) on top	Seven ascending steps of the scale (+7) [ascending octave]	<pre><neume intm="+8" intmb="+7"> <neume func="melodic" name="oligon" pos="main"/> <neume func="melodic" name="kendima" pos="above"/> <neume func="melodic" name="ipsili" pos="top"/> </neume></pre>
	Khamēlé or Chamēlé (Hamilí) + Elafrón (Elafrón) below + Apóstrophos (Apóstrofos) on the bottom	Seven descending steps of the scale (-7) [descending octave]	<pre><neume intm="-8" intmb="-7"> <neume func="melodic" name="hamili" pos="main"/> <neume func="melodic" name="elafron" pos="below"/> <neume func="melodic" name="apostrofos" pos="bottom"/> </neume></pre>

Compound Interval Neumes EXAMPLES

Shape	Name	Meaning	Encoding
	Oligon (Olígon) + Kéntēma (Kéndima) above + Hypsēlé (Ipsilí) front right	Six ascending steps of the scale (+6) [ascending seventh]	<pre><neume intm="+7" intmb="+6"> <neume func="melodic" name="oligon" pos="main"/> <neume func="melodic" name="kendima" pos="above"/> <neume func="melodic" name="ipsili" pos="front right"/> </neume></pre>
	Oligon (Olígon) + Kéntēma (Kéndima) above + Hypsēlé (Ipsilí) on top	Seven ascending steps of the scale (+7) [ascending octave]	<pre><neume intm="+8" intmb="+7"> <neume func="melodic" name="oligon" pos="main"/> <neume func="melodic" name="kendima" pos="above"/> <neume func="melodic" name="ipsili" pos="top"/> </neume></pre>
	Khamēlé or Chamēlé (Hamilí) + Elafrón (Elafrón) below + Apóstrophos (Apóstrofos) on the bottom	Seven descending steps of the scale (-7) [descending octave]	<pre><neume intm="-8" intmb="-7"> <neume func="melodic" name="hamili" pos="main"/> <neume func="melodic" name="elafron" pos="below"/> <neume func="melodic" name="apostrofos" pos="bottom"/> </neume></pre>

Temporal Neumes @func temporal

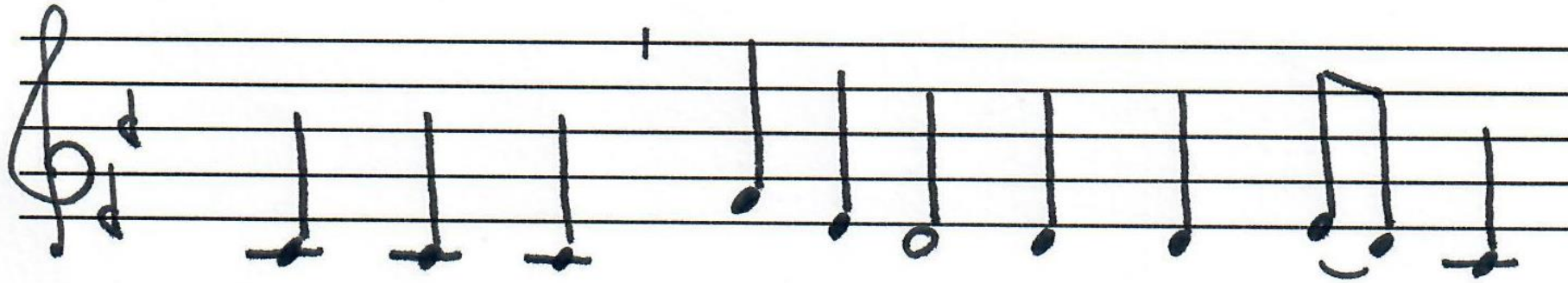
Shape	Name	Encoding	Effect (1 beat = 1 quarter note)
	klasma	<neume func="temporal" name="klasma"/>	Adds one beat (+1)
	apli	<neume func="temporal" name="apli"/>	Adds one beat (+1)
	dipli	<neume func="temporal" name="dipli"/>	Adds two beats (+2)
	tripli	<neume func="temporal" name="tripli"/>	Adds three beats (+3)
	argon	<neume func="temporal" name="argon"/>	Divides the first note's beat in two (1/2) & adds one beat to the last note (+1)
	triimiargon	<neume func="temporal" name="triimiargon"/>	Divides the first note's beat in two (1/2) & adds two beats to the last note (+2)
	diargon	<neume func="temporal" name="diargon"/>	Divides the first note's beat in two (1/2) & adds three beats to the last note (+3)
	gorgon	<neume func="temporal" name="gorgon"/>	Divides beat in two (1/2)
	digorgon	<neume func="temporal" name="digorgon"/>	Divides beat in three (1/3)
	trigorgon	<neume func="temporal" name="trigorgon"/>	Divides beat in four (1/4)
With Dots			
	dotted digorgon	<neume func="temporal" name="digorgon" dots="1" dots.gorgon="1" dots.pos="left"/>	
		<neume func="temporal" name="digorgon" dots="1" dots.gorgon="2" dots.pos="left"/>	
		<neume func="temporal" name="digorgon" dots="1" dots.gorgon="2" dots.pos="right"/>	

Dynamic/
Ornamental
Neumes
@func
dynamic/
ornamental

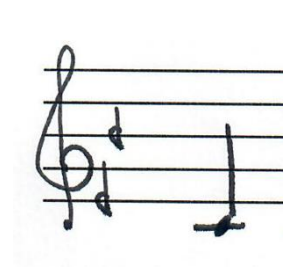
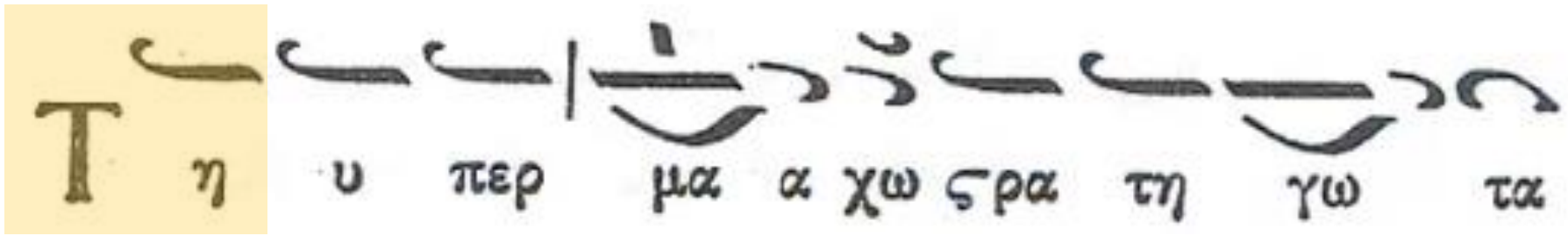
Shape	Name	Encoding	Description
	varia	<neume func="dynamic/ornamental" name="varia"/>	with heaviness
	omalon	<neume func="dynamic/ornamental" name="omalon"/>	with an ondulation of the voice
	antikenoma	<neume func="dynamic/ornamental" name="antikenoma"/>	with a flight / like suspended ...
	psifiston	<neume func="dynamic/ornamental" name="psifiston"/>	with strength and lively
	eteron	<neume func="dynamic/ornamental" name="eteron"/>	legato, with smooth ondulation of the voice
	endofonon	<neume func="dynamic/ornamental" name="endofonon"/>	bouche fermée (with a shut mouth)
	stavros	<neume func="dynamic/ornamental" name="stavros"/>	respiration

Example: Ti ypermacho

Τ η υ περ μα α χω ς ρ α τη γω τα

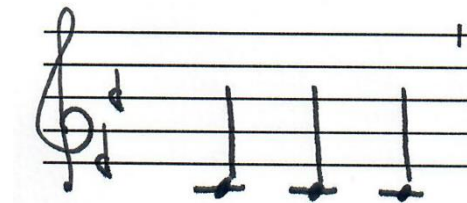
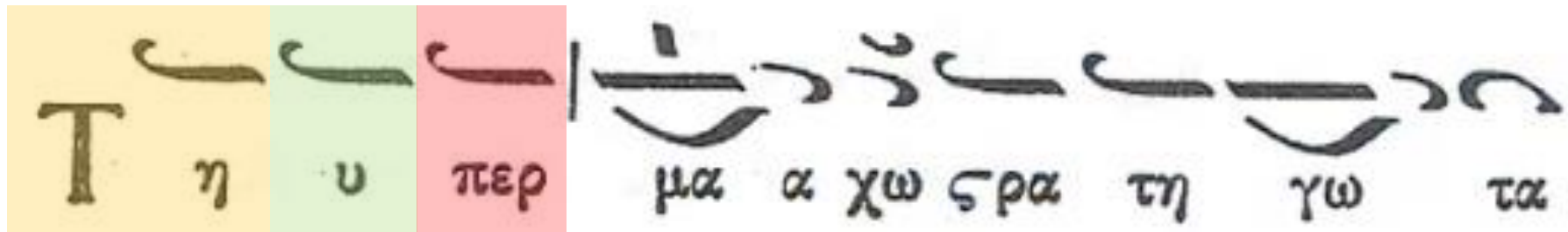


25



```
<syllable>  
  <syl>Ti</syl>  
  <neume xml:id="neume001" func="melodic" name="ison"  
    dur="4" intmb="0" pname="c"/>  
</syllable>
```

Word:
“Ti”



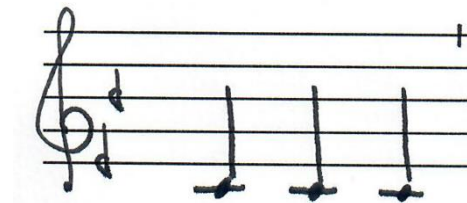
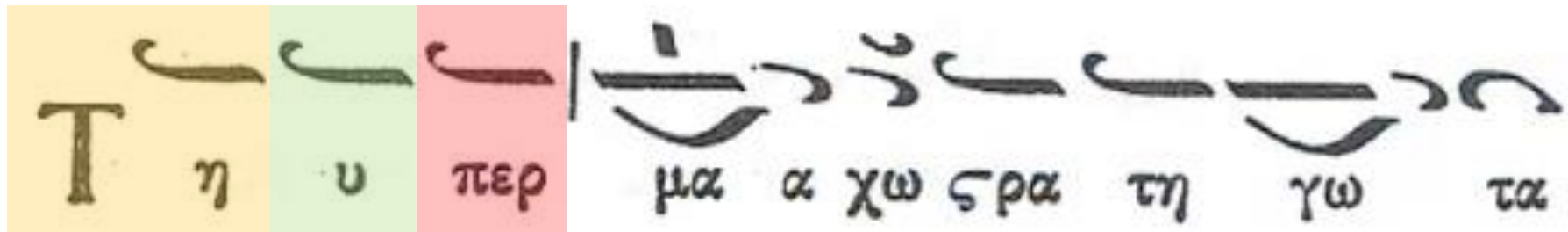
```
<syllable>
  <syl>Ti</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume001" func="melodic" name="ison"
    dur="4" intmb="0" pname="c"/>
</syllable>
```

Word:

“Ti”

Word:

“ypermacho”

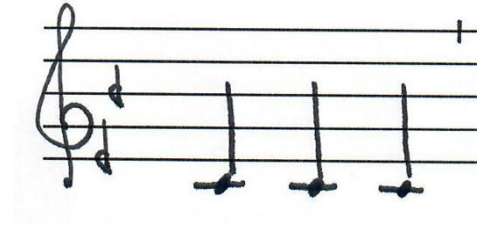
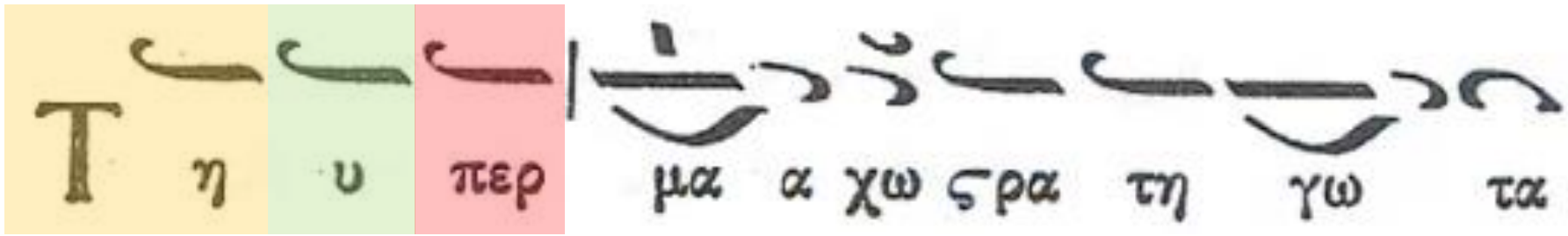


```
<syllable>
  <syl>Ti</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume001" func="melodic" name="ison"
    dur="4" intmb="0" pname="c"/>
</syllable>
```

Word:
“**Ti**”

```
<syllable>
  <syl>Y-</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume002" func="melodic" name="ison"
    dur="4" intmb="0" pname="c"/>
</syllable>
```

Word:
“**ypermacho**”



```
<syllable>
  <syl>Ti</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume001" func="melodic" name="ison"
    dur="4" intmb="0" pname="c"/>
</syllable>
```

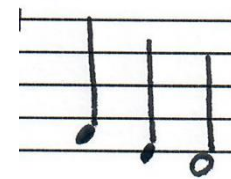
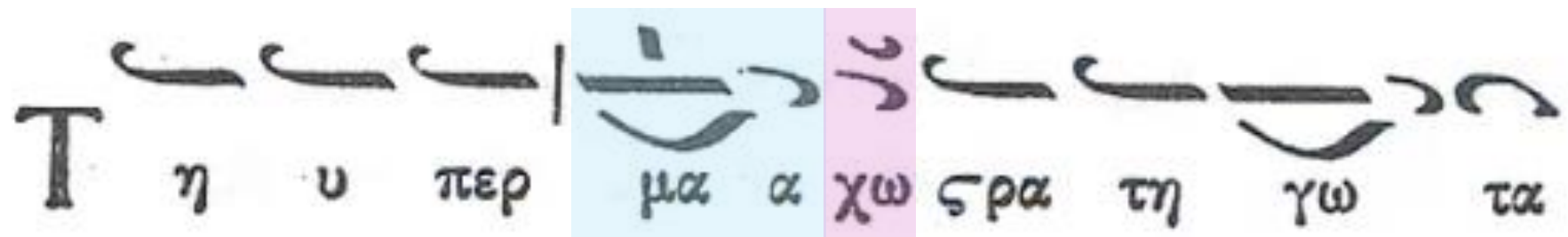
Word:
“**Ti**”

```
<syllable>
  <syl>Y-</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume002" func="melodic" name="ison"
    dur="4" intmb="0" pname="c"/>
</syllable>
```

Word:

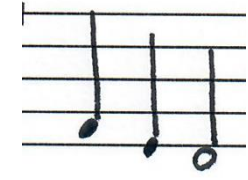
```
<syllable>
  <syl>per-</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume003" func="melodic" name="ison"
    dur="4" intmb="0" pname="c"/>
</syllable>
```

“**ypermacho**”

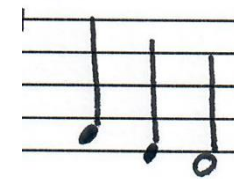
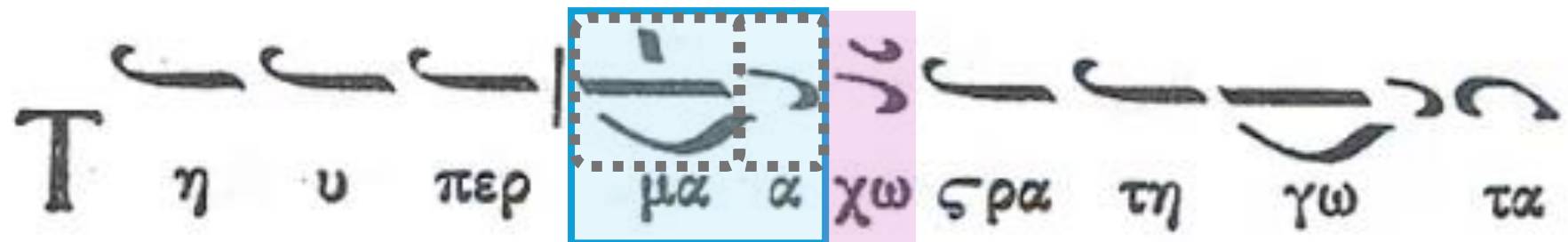


continue
with word
“ypermachō”

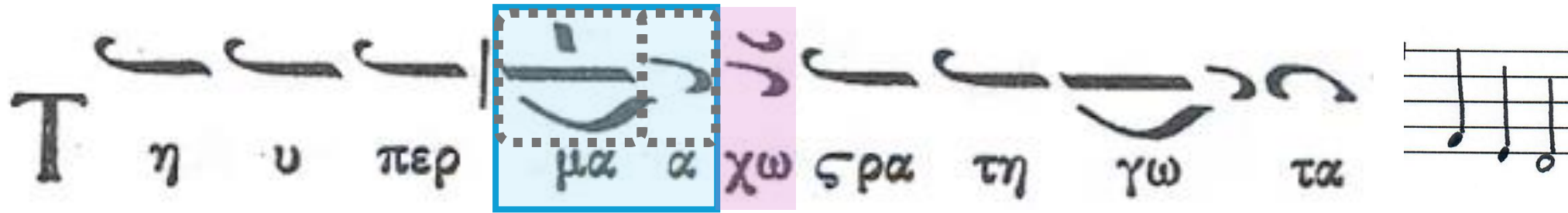
Τ η υ περ μα α χω ς ρ α τη γω τα



continue
with word
“ypermachō”

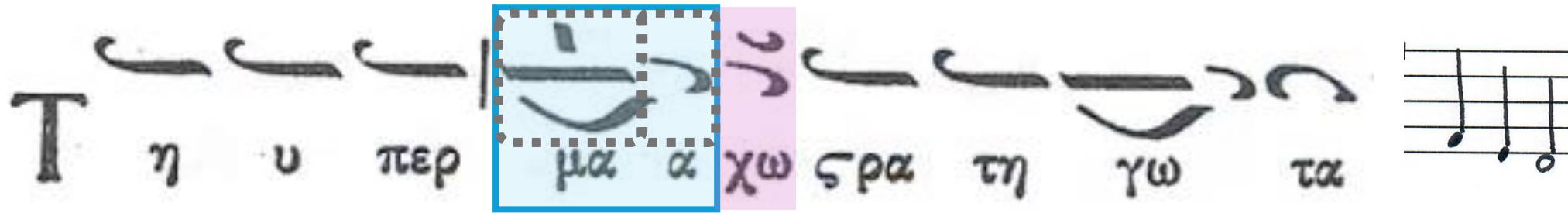


continue
with word
“ypermachō”



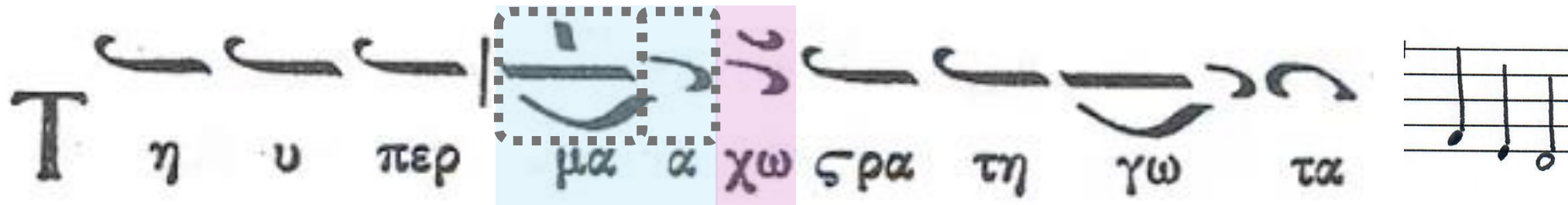
continue
with word
“ypermacho”

```
<syllable>
  <syl>ma-</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume004" dur="4" intmb="+3" intm="+4" pname="f">
    <neume xml:id="neume005" func="melodic" name="oligon" pos="main"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume006" func="melodic" name="kendima" pos="above"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume007" func="dynamic/ornamental" name="psifiston" pos="below"/>
  </neume>
  <neume xml:id="neume008" func="melodic" name="apostrofos" dur="4" intmb="-1"
    intm="-2" pname="e"/>
</syllable>
```



continue
with word
“ypermacho”

```
<syllable>
  <syl>ma-</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume004" dur="4" intmb="+3" intm="+4" pname="f">
    <neume xml:id="neume005" func="melodic" name="oligon" pos="main"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume006" func="melodic" name="kendima" pos="above"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume007" func="dynamic/ornamental" name="psifiston" pos="below"/>
  </neume>
  <neume xml:id="neume008" func="melodic" name="apostrofos" dur="4" intmb="-1"
    intm="-2" pname="e"/>
</syllable>
```



continue
with word
“ypermacho”

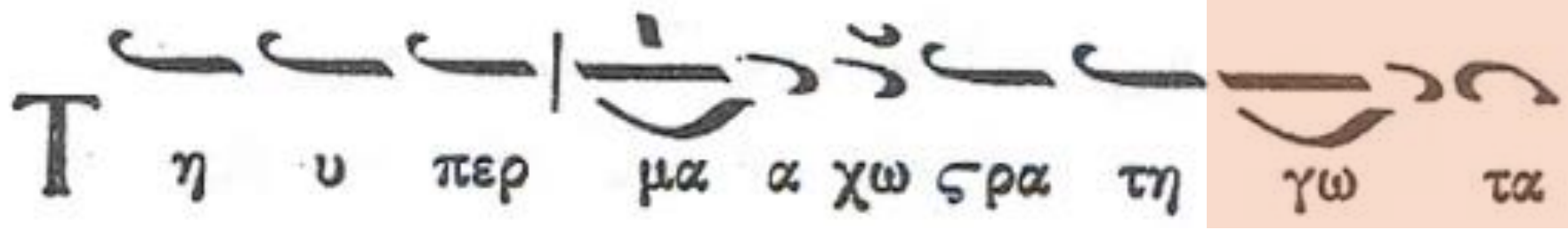
```
<syllable>
  <syl>ma-</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume004" dur="4" intmb="+3" intm="+4" pname="f">
    <neume xml:id="neume005" func="melodic" name="oligon" pos="main"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume006" func="melodic" name="kendima" pos="above"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume007" func="dynamic/ornamental" name="psifiston" pos="below"/>
  </neume>
  <neume xml:id="neume008" func="melodic" name="apostrofos" dur="4" intmb="-1"
    intm="-2" pname="e"/>
</syllable>
```

```
<syllable>
  <syl>cho</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume009" dur="2" intmb="-1" intm="-2" pname="d">
    <neume xml:id="neume010" func="melodic" name="apostrofos" pos="main"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume011" func="temporal" name="klasma" pos="above"/>
  </neume>
</syllable>
```

We have
already
seen this
one

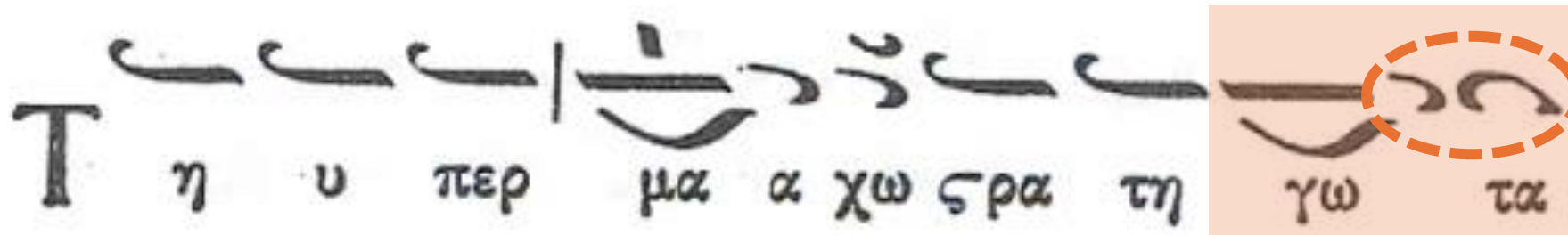
T η υ περ μα α χω ς ρα τη
 γω τα



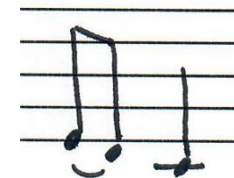


→ formulas



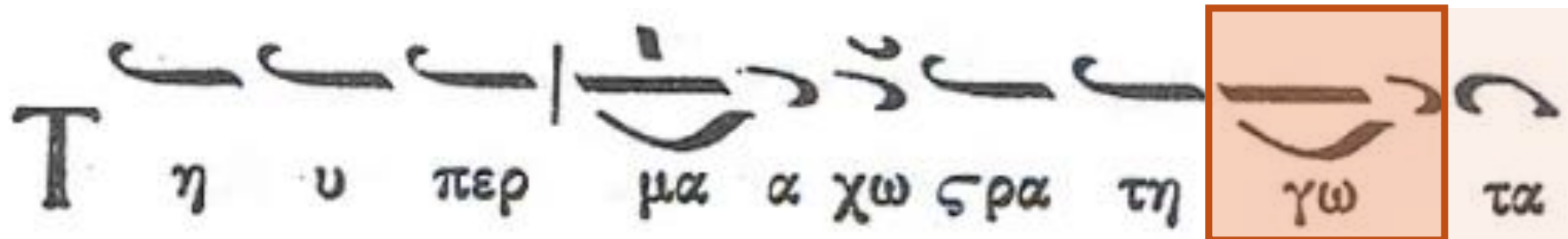


→ formulas

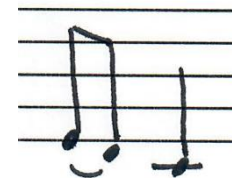


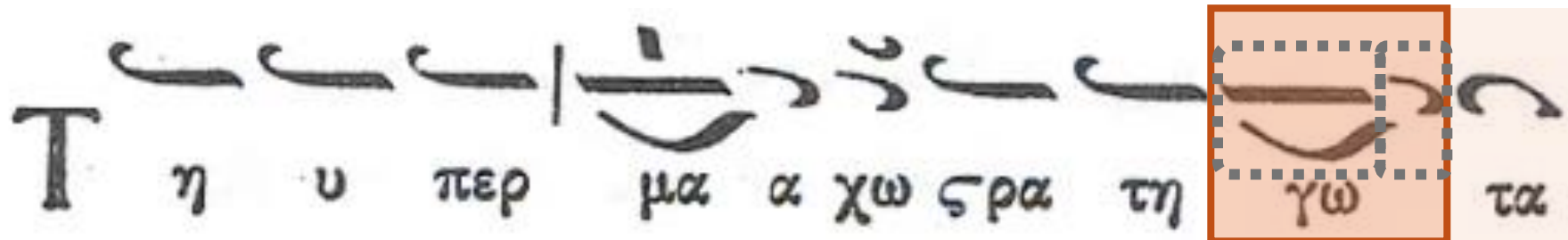
Syneches Elafron

*Two descending steps [-1 -1], so **two notes** in downward scalar movement, with **the first note** (the **apostrofos**) having a duration of an **eighth note** and lying on the same beat (quarter note) as the **preceding note** & with the second note of the scalar movement being a quarter note*

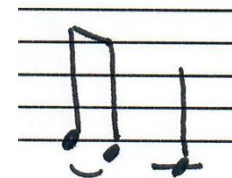


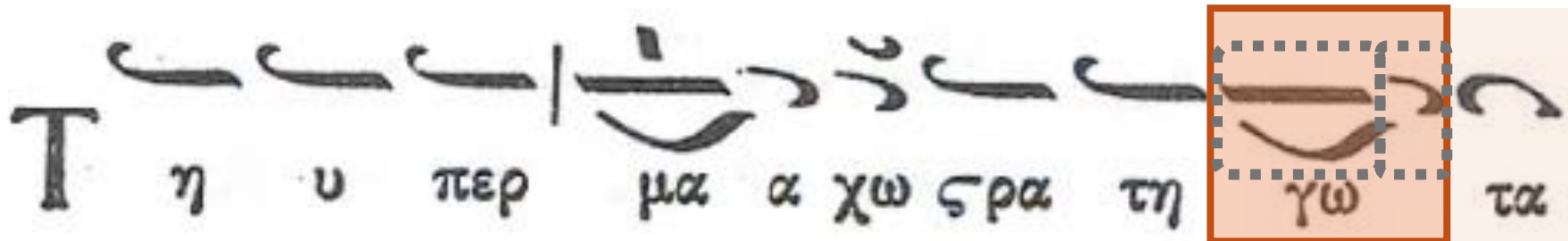
→ formulas



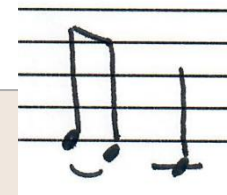


→ formulas

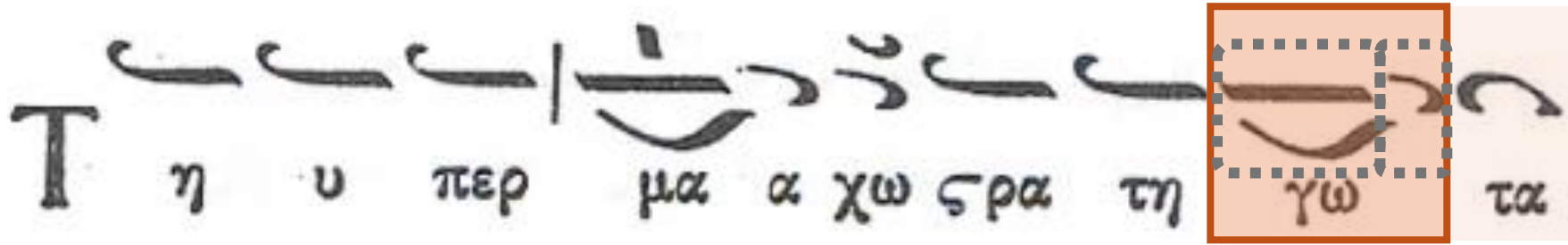




→ formulas



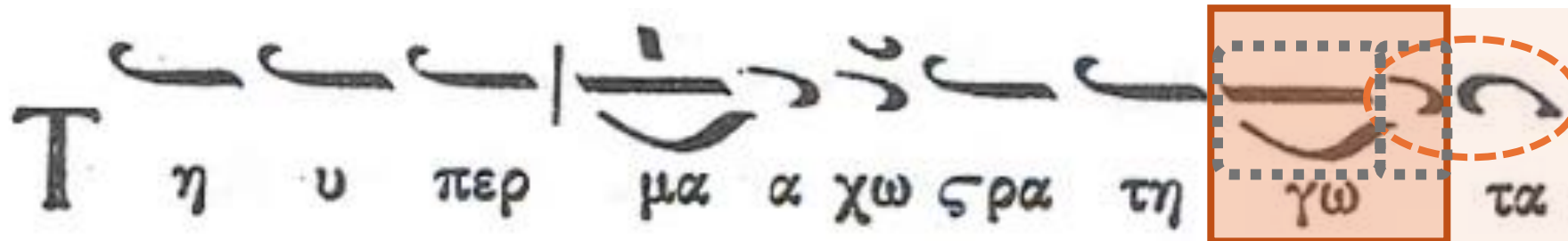
```
<syllable>
  <syl>go</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume014" dur="8" intmb="+1" intm="+2" pname="e" slur="i">
    <neume xml:id="neume015" func="melodic" name="oligon" pos="main"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume016" func="dynamic/ornamental" name="psifiston" pos="below"/>
  </neume>
  <neume xml:id="neume017" func="melodic" name="apostrofos-of-syneches-elafron"
    dur="8" intmb="-1" intm="-2" pname="d" slur="t"/>
</syllable>
```



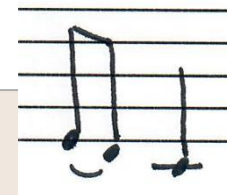
→ formulas



```
<syllable>
  <syl>go</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume014" dur="8" intmb="+1" intm="+2" pname="e" slur="i">
    <neume xml:id="neume015" func="melodic" name="oligon" pos="main"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume016" func="dynamic/ornamental" name="psifiston" pos="below"/>
  </neume>
  <neume xml:id="neume017" func="melodic" name="apostrofos-of-syneches-elafron"
    dur="8" intmb="-1" intm="-2" pname="d" slur="t"/>
</syllable>
```



→ formulas

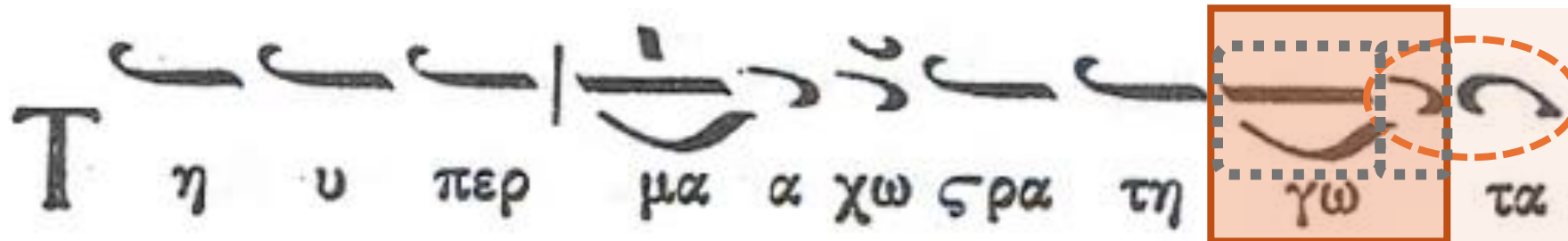


```
<syllable>
  <syl>go</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume014" dur="8" intmb="+1" intm="+2" pname="e" slur="i">
    <neume xml:id="neume015" func="melodic" name="oligon" pos="main"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume016" func="dynamic/ornamental" name="psifiston" pos="below"/>
  </neume>
  <neume xml:id="neume017" func="melodic" name="apostrofos-of-syneches-elafron"
    dur="8" intmb="-1" intm="-2" pname="d" slur="t"/>
</syllable>
```

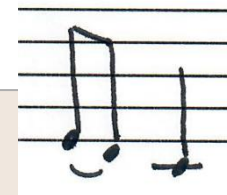


Syneches Elafron

*Two descending steps [-1 -1], so **two notes** in downward scalar movement, with **the first note** (the **apostrofos**) having a duration of an **eighth note** and **lying on the same beat** (quarter note) as the **preceding note** & with the second note of the scalar movement being a quarter note*



→ formulas

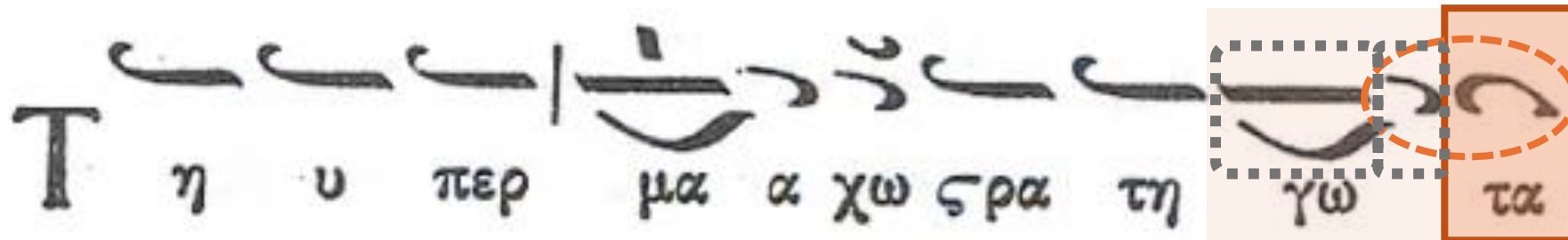


```
<syllable>
  <syl>go</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume014" dur="8" intmb="+1" intm="+2" pname="e" slur="i">
    <neume xml:id="neume015" func="melodic" name="oligon" pos="main"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume016" func="dynamic/ornamental" name="psifiston" pos="below"/>
  </neume>
  <neume xml:id="neume017" func="melodic" name="apostrofos-of-syneches-elafron"
    dur="8" intmb="-1" intm="-2" pname="d" slur="t"/>
</syllable>
```

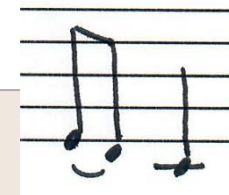


Syneches Elafron

*Two descending steps [-1 -1], so two notes in downward scalar movement, with the first note (the apostrofos) having a duration of an eighth note and lying on the same beat (quarter note) as the preceding note
& with the second note of the scalar movement being a quarter note*

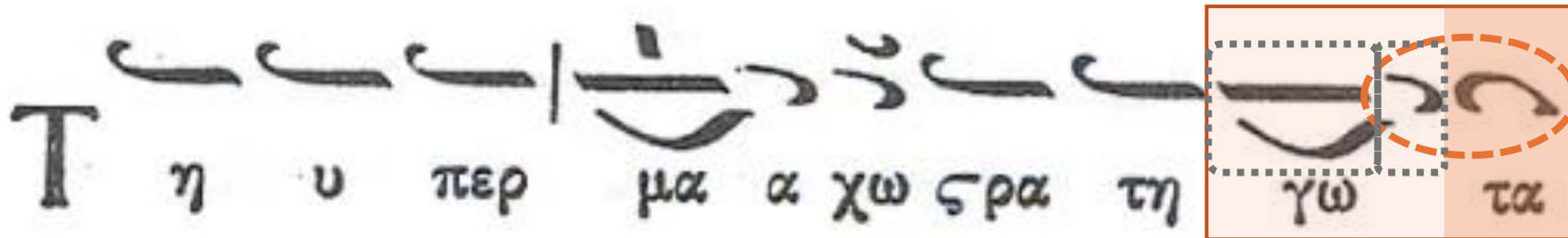


→ formulas

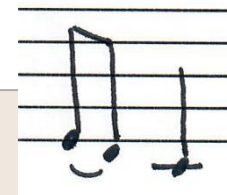


```
<syllable>
  <syl>go</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume014" dur="8" intmb="+1" intm="+2" pname="e" slur="i">
    <neume xml:id="neume015" func="melodic" name="oligon" pos="main"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume016" func="dynamic/ornamental" name="psifiston" pos="below"/>
  </neume>
  <neume xml:id="neume017" func="melodic" name="apostrofos-of-syneches-elafron"
    dur="8" intmb="-1" intm="-2" pname="d" slur="t"/>
</syllable>
```

```
<syllable>
  <syl>ta</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume018" func="melodic" name="syneches-elafron" dur="4" intmb="-1"
    intm="-2" pname="c"/>
</syllable>
```

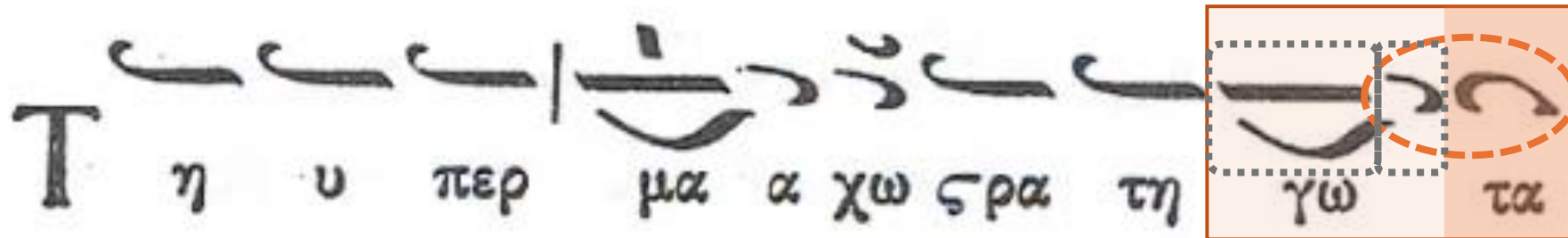


→ formulas

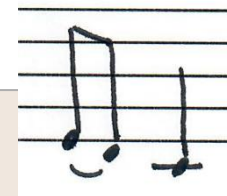


```
<syllable>
  <syl>go</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume014" dur="8" intmb="+1" intm="+2" pname="e" slur="i">
    <neume xml:id="neume015" func="melodic" name="oligon" pos="main"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume016" func="dynamic/ornamental" name="psifiston" pos="below"/>
  </neume>
  <neume xml:id="neume017" func="melodic" name="apostrofos-of-syneches-elafron"
    dur="8" intmb="-1" intm="-2" pname="d" slur="t"/>
</syllable>
```

```
<syllable>
  <syl>ta</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume018" func="melodic" name="syneches-elafron" dur="4" intmb="-1"
    intm="-2" pname="c"/>
</syllable>
```



→ formulas



```
<syllable>
  <syl>go</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume014" dur="8" intmb="+1" intm="+2" pname="e" slur="i">
    <neume xml:id="neume015" func="melodic" name="oligon" pos="main"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume016" func="dynamic/ornamental" name="psifiston" pos="below"/>
  </neume>
  <neume xml:id="neume017" func="melodic" name="apostrofos-of-syneches-elafron"
    dur="8" intmb="-1" intm="-2" pname="d" slur="t"/>
</syllable>
```

```
<syllable>
  <syl>ta</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume018" func="melodic" name="syneches-elafron" dur="4" intmb="-1"
    intm="-2" pname="c"/>
</syllable>
```

```
<formula type="syneches-elafron" startid="#neume014" endid="#neume018"/>
```

Encoding of Byzantine Neumes in MEI

We covered the encoding of various types of neumes:

- Melodic, temporal, and dynamic/ornamental
- How to encode “basic neumes”
- How to encode “neume combinations”
- Where to include the duration and pitch information

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Other features that are also supported: mode signatures, tone signatures, attractions, and more formulas

for the full encoding of the *Ti ypermacho*:

<https://github.com/ECHOES-from-the-Past/mei-byzantine-neumes/>

(see handout)

The Future

- **Automatic transcription into staff notation:**
Everything needed for a schematic transcription is in the MEI Byzantine Neumes file (e.g., pitch and duration information)
- **Optical Music Recognition (OMR):**
There is already an encoding system (MEI) for the OMR to generate
- **Computational music analysis:**
MEI file is a machine-readable file
Examples: music density / music texture, melodic searches, recurring patterns – formulas, rhythmic analysis
- **Long term:** Digital editions (with the music text linked to facsimile, recordings, and various metadata)
- **Long term:** Big data analysis

Thank you 😊

- Echoes from the Past: Unveiling a Lost Soundscape with Digital Analysis (2022.01957.PTDC)
 - Digital Analysis of Chant Transmission - SSHRC Partnership Grant (895-2023-1002)

Extra Slides (for Q&A)

Encoding of other notational symbols:

accidentals, mode signature, key signature

Attractions

- Encoded as **attributes**:
 - @**accid**: written accidental
 - @**accid.ges**: implicit accidental (i.e., implied by a tone signature)
- To be used in **<neume>**
 OR in a child **<accid>** when more attributes need to be provided (e.g., @**pos** to indicate the position of the accidental relative to the “main neume”)

shape	meaning	encoding
	2 microtones flat (out of twelve microtones)	@accid = 2twf
	4 microtones flat (out of twelve microtones)	@accid = 4twf
	6 microtones flat (out of twelve microtones)	@accid = 6twf
	8 microtones flat (out of twelve microtones)	@accid = 8twf
	2 microtones sharp (out of twelve microtones)	@accid = 2tws
	4 microtones sharp (out of twelve microtones)	@accid = 4tws
	6 microtones sharp (out of twelve microtones)	@accid = 6tws
	8 microtones sharp (out of twelve microtones)	@accid = 8tws

Mode signature: `<modeSig>`

- Beginning of the piece
- First element in `<layer>`, preceding all the `<syllable>` elements

```
<modeSig mode.num="4" mode="plagal" pname="c" fthora="true"  
genre="diatonic" nuance="soft"/>
```

- Attributes:
 - `@mode.num` = 1, 2, 3, 4
 - `@mode` = authentic, plagal (extend current values)
 - `@pname` = b (Zo), c (Ni), d (Pa), e (Vu), f (Ga), g (Di), a (Ke)
 - `@fthora` = true, false
 - `@genre` = diatonic, chromatic, enharmonic
 - `@nuance` = soft, tense
 - `@mode.branch` (optional) = diphonos, triphonos, pentaphonos, eptaphonos, antiphonos, naos

Tone signature: <toneSig>

- Child of <layer>
- To be used when the tone signature **changes**:
 - Preceded by the <syllable> elements of the previous tone
 - Followed by the <syllable> elements in the new tone

```
<toneSig pname="e" register="middle"  
genre="diatonic" nuance="soft"/>
```

- Attributes:
 - @pname = b (*Zo*), c (*Ni*), d (*Pa*), e (*Vu*), f (*Ga*), g (*Di*), a (*Ke*)
 - @register = low, middle, high
 - @genre = diatonic, chromatic, enharmonic
 - @nuance = soft, tense

Extra Slides (for Q&A)

The two edge cases: *dyo kendimata with oligon* and *iporro*

Special case: dyo kendimata with oligon

- **Exception! It is not the “parent neume” that contains the pitch and duration information**
- This is because: in a *dyo kendimata with oligon*, either above or below, each neume (‘oligon’ and ‘dyo kendimata’) has its own pitch and duration



```
<neume xml:id="neume084">
  <neume func="melodic" name="oligon" pos="main"
    dur="4" intm="+2" intmb="+1" pname="d" slur="i"/>
  <neume func="melodic" name="dyo-kendimata" pos="above"
    dur="4" intm="+2" intmb="+1" pname="e" slur="t"/>
</neume>
```

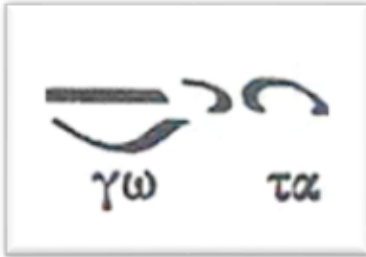

Extra Slides (for Q&A)

Final cadence & other formulas

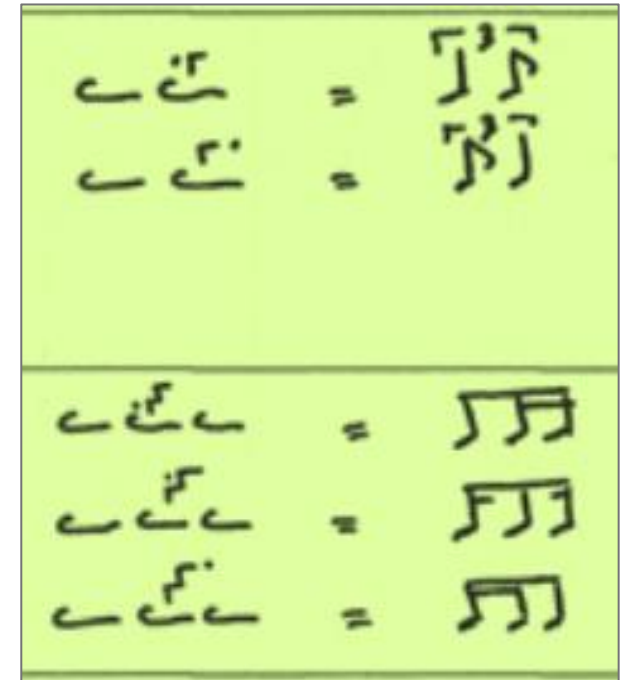
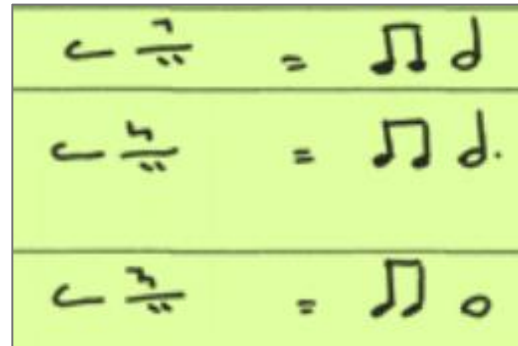
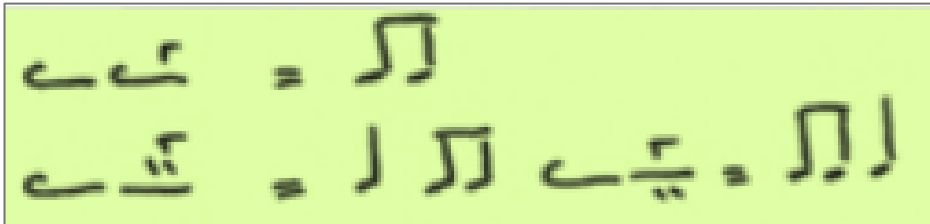
Formulas

```
<formula startid="#REF1" endid="#REF2"/>
```

- Syneches elafron:

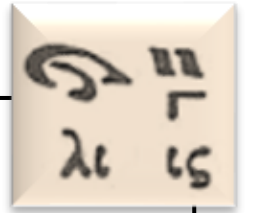


- With gorgon or argon:



Formulas

```
<formula startid="#REF1" endid="#REF2"/>
```



```
<syllable>
  <syl>lis</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume072" dur="8" intmb="-3" intm="-4" pname="d" slur="i">
    <neume xml:id="neume073" func="melodic" name="elafron" pos="main"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume074" func="melodic" name="apostrofos" pos="below"/>
  </neume>
  <neume xml:id="neume075" intmb="+1" intm="+2" pname="e" dur="8" slur="t">
    <neume xml:id="neume076" func="melodic" name="dio kendimata" pos="main"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume077" func="temporal" name="gorgon" pos="below"
      effect="#neume072 #neume075"/>
  </neume>
  <formula type="with-gorgon" startid="#neume072" endid="#neume075"/>
</syllable>
```

Gorgon effect: previous neume and the first of the present one

```

<syllable>
  <syl>te-</syl>
  <neume xml:id="neume173" dur="4" dots="1" intmb="0" pname="d" slur="i">
    <neume xml:id="neume174" func="melodic" name="ison" pos="main"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume175" func="temporal" name="klasma" pos="above"/>
  </neume>
  <neume xml:id="neume176">
    <neume xml:id="neume177" func="melodic" name="iporroï" pos="main">
      <note xml:id="neume177-note001" dur="8" intmb="-1" intm="-2" pname="c" slur="m"/>
      <note xml:id="neume177-note002" dur="4" intmb="-1" intm="-2" pname="b" slur="t"/>
    </neume>
    <neume xml:id="neume178" name="gorgon" pos="above" effect="#neume173 #neume177-note001"/>
  </neume>
  <neume xml:id="neume179" func="melodic" name="apostrofos" dur="8" intmb="-1" intm="-2"
  pname="a" slur="i"/>
  <neume xml:id="neume180">
    <neume xml:id="neume181" name="dyo-kendimata" dur="8" intmb="+1" intm="+2" pname="b"
    pos="below" slur="m"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume182" name="oligon" dur="2" dots="1" intmb="+1" intm="+2" pname="c"
    pos="main" slur="t"/>
    <neume xml:id="neume183" name="triimiargon" pos="above" effect="#neume179 #neume181
    #neume182"/>
  </neume>
  <formula type="with-argon" startid="#neume173" endid="#neume180"/>
</syllable>

```

95 = 5 1/2

